

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen's US Point Person Bows Out — What It Means for the Payments Race

A senior US executive at Adyen has exited, and that's not just a line item on an org chart. The Netherlands-based payments processor has been leaning hard into North America to win big enterprise merchants and platform partners—where the competition from Stripe, PayPal, Worldpay and FIS is fiercest. Leadership changes in this region can slow momentum: think longer sales cycles, more cautious procurement teams, and rivals sniffing around key accounts. But here's the other side. Adyen's pitch has always been product-led—one global platform for cards, APMs and risk, with fewer handoffs and better data. If execution truly lives in the platform and not personalities, the near-term impact could be contained. What should executives watch? Continuity in US go-to-market, retention of strategic merchants, and any signs of pricing or incentive tweaks to defend share. If Adyen quickly backfills the role with a seasoned operator—and keeps shipping features that cut checkout friction and boost authorization rates—the narrative stays intact. If hiring drags or merchant wins slow, expect rivals to press their advantage and investors to question the US growth runway.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/news/adyen-us-executive-exits/805752/>

Article 2

Adyen leans into BNPL with Klarna as holiday shopping heats up

Buy Now, Pay Later is set for another holiday surge, and Adyen is plugging the Swedish BNPL giant Klarna deeper into its checkout pipes to catch the wave. The idea is simple: merchants using Adyen's single integration can switch on BNPL alongside cards and wallets, online and in-store, and let Klarna shoulder the credit risk while Adyen handles the payments plumbing. What does this mean? Higher conversion rates and bigger baskets for merchants, more processed volume and stickier relationships for Adyen, and flexible payment options for shoppers who are watching their budgets. The trade-offs are real—BNPL faces regulatory scrutiny and merchant fee pressure—but Adyen stays largely insulated from delinquencies because it's not the lender. Strategically, this is Adyen doubling down on being the orchestration layer that routes to whatever payment method converts best, strengthening its pitch against Stripe, PayPal, and local acquirers. The holiday season will test scale and reliability. If the pipes hold and the checkout lifts materialize, Adyen's "do-everything" toolkit gets a timely, demand-driven boost.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 3

Adyen taps Plaid to push Pay-by-Bank and tame ACH risk

Adyen just teamed up with Plaid to give merchants a cleaner path to bank linked payments. Think “Pay by Bank” buttons powered by Plaid’s slick account linking and data, wrapped in Adyen’s acquiring, checkout, and risk stack. Translation: fewer ACH failures, faster account verification, better fraud controls, and lower acceptance costs by skipping card rails. Why this matters: card fees keep creeping up and margins are tight, so merchants are hunting for cheaper tender types without killing conversion. Open banking has been promising, but clunky UX and ACH returns (NSF, fraud) held it back. Plaid’s tooling—instant account validation, balance checks, and risk signals—helps fix that. For Adyen, it’s a strategic nudge toward account to account payments across high ticket checkouts, bill pay, subscriptions, and marketplace flows. It also shores up its enterprise appeal as rivals like Stripe and Checkout.com tout similar bank pay options. Don’t expect cards to vanish—ACH settlement isn’t instant and consumer habits are sticky—but merchants now have a more compelling lever to trim costs. If adoption holds, expect more “Pay by Bank” at checkout and quieter card volumes where savings beat swipe.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 4

Adyen doubles down on embedded finance for platforms

On July 12, 2022 in San Francisco, Adyen announced a push deeper into embedded finance—rolling out tools that let marketplaces, SaaS firms and gig platforms offer financial services (think faster payouts, card issuing and business accounts) through a single integration. The pitch is simple: platforms can become “money-native” without building a bank, while Adyen handles the messy bits—compliance, risk, and global payouts. What it means: payments players aren’t just charging swipe fees anymore; they’re chasing richer revenue streams like interchange, float, and lending economics. For platforms, bundling money services boosts retention and monetization, and for Adyen, it’s a way to increase take rates and defend against Stripe, PayPal and Block in North America. The catch? More services mean more underwriting, fraud, and regulatory overhead—so execution and risk controls matter. If you run a platform, this is a nudge that embedded finance is moving from nice-to-have to table stakes. Adyen wants to be the plumbing behind that shift, promising fewer vendors, faster go lives, and a bigger slice of your unit economics.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 5

Square switches on bitcoin payments for small businesses

Square is flipping the crypto switch for its merchants, letting small businesses accept bitcoin at checkout. It's a way to ride the "emerging tech" wave without forcing mom-and-pop stores to become crypto pros. Strategically, this matters: Square's vast POS footprint could turn bitcoin from a speculative asset into just another tender type. The pitch? Reach crypto-native customers, potentially trim reliance on card rails, and settle quickly. The catch? Price volatility, tax headaches for consumers, and new playbooks for refunds and disputes—bitcoin transactions are irreversible.

Expect Square to blunt the risk with instant fiat conversion and compliance tooling, a model peers like PayPal, Shopify and Coinbase Commerce already lean on. For payment execs, watch the economics: if spend routes off card networks, interchange and fraud dynamics shift; if it doesn't, merchants still get a marketing halo ("We accept Bitcoin") with limited operational drag. Either way, the signal is clear—platforms are hedging for a future where wallets, not traditional networks, decide what money looks like. The near-term test is simple: will crypto curiosity translate into everyday checkout behavior?

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Article 6

Square's new Handheld takes the phone out of the POS equation

Square built its name on tiny readers that turned smartphones into card machines. Now it's cutting the phone out entirely. The company's new "Handheld" is a palm-sized, all in one POS that lets staff take payments anywhere without pairing a separate reader to a personal device. Think fewer Bluetooth hiccups, less BYOD headache, and a setup tailored for line busting in quick service restaurants, pop ups, and shop floors.

Why it matters: This is Square doubling down on owning the in store experience. A purpose built handheld keeps sellers inside Square's hardware software stack, where the real money is in payments volume and subscriptions, not gadget margins. It also helps Square counter rivals like Toast, Clover and Lightspeed that already tout rugged mobile terminals, and it hedges against Apple's Tap to Pay making phones a commodity—some merchants prefer fleet managed devices with consistent UX, battery and durability.

If Handheld sticks, expect stickier merchants and higher throughput at peak times, which translates to more Gross Payment Volume flowing through Block. In short: Square began by piggybacking on your phone; now it wants to be the phone—at least for checkout.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Square brews Bitcoin at checkout as Compass Coffee goes first

Buying a latte with Bitcoin has long been a crypto flex. This week, a Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C. actually did it — becoming the first store to accept a bitcoin payment on Square's new point of sale. It's a small transaction, but a big signal: Block (Square's parent) is moving Bitcoin from investment apps into everyday checkout, wrapping the complexity so it feels like any other tap-to-pay. Why this matters: if Square can make crypto payments as seamless as cards, merchants get access to an alternative rail that could lower acceptance costs on small tickets and tap into a new customer segment. It also nudges the industry to rethink settlement — final, push-based payments without chargebacks can be attractive. But there's reality to contend with: consumer habits, price volatility, tax reporting on spends, and regulatory scrutiny will keep volumes modest for now. For payment execs, treat this as a live experiment in mainstreaming crypto rails within POS: monitor the economics, conversion options, speed, and support burden. The latte is small; the strategic test is not.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

